

What's actually worth fixing **before you list.**

Your seller asks what to spend money on. Here is a straight answer on the five exterior conditions we get called about most, including the ones where our honest advice is to do nothing. Forward this to a client if it helps.

WHAT YOU'RE LOOKING AT	OUR HONEST READ	BALLPARK
Fence leaning, or posts rotted at grade	Fix it. Cheapest visible improvement on this list, and it is the first thing a buyer registers walking into the yard. Often a post-and-brace repair rather than a full replacement.	\$32–\$48 per linear ft
Deck structurally sound, just grey and tired	Clean and re-stain. Do not replace. A few hundred dollars does most of what a rebuild would do for the listing photos. Replacing a sound deck before a sale rarely returns its cost.	Staining only
Deck soft underfoot, or failing at the ledger	Fix it, or disclose it. This shows up in inspection either way. A surprise during option period costs more in renegotiation than the repair would have.	\$30–\$75 per sq ft
Roof at end of life, no active leak	Get the estimate. Usually do not replace. A written quote in your seller's hand often does more at the negotiating table than spending the money would. We will write one free.	\$11,000–\$18,000 if replaced
Bare slab, no shade on a west-facing patio	Skip it before a sale. A cover is a wonderful project for someone staying put. It does not return its cost inside a 30-day listing window.	—

Figures are our published cost guides at jbcontractingatx.com, not sales pricing. Where a project lands depends on size, access and finish level.

How the pre-listing walkthrough works

1. **Text John the address** and the date you need it photo-ready.
2. **He walks it, usually within two days.** You do not need to be there.
3. **Written estimate within 48 hours**, line-itemed so your seller can pick and choose instead of facing one intimidating number.
4. **If they proceed, we schedule to your date** and text progress photos daily, to you as well as the seller.

What you get that you may not be used to

- **A real yes or no on your date.** If we cannot hit it we say so, rather than take the job and miss it.
- **An honest "don't bother."** Sometimes the answer is to spend nothing. We would rather keep the relationship.
- **One call for the fence, the deck and the roof**, instead of three contractors and three schedules.
- **You get John.** He owns the company and he is on the job.

Bring us to your next sales meeting. We will bring lunch for the office and John will spend twenty minutes on what adds value before a listing and what wastes a seller's money. No slide deck, no sign-up sheet. Just a contractor answering the questions your agents field every week.

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Call or text anytime. A photo of the space is plenty to start.

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